

Management meeting 12 January 2026 – Minutes

Present: M Way, J Lyne, G Sykes, V Raven, R Vince, J Craig, C Mills, M Dixon, H Acland, H Massey

1. Apologies: K Browne- Martin, M Hart, A Harvey (Minutes taken from recordings)
2. Welcome to New Committee Members : C Mills (Committee Member + Sailability), H Acland (Sailing Secretary), M Dixon (Communications Officer)
3. Minutes of last meeting: Agreed
4. Matters arising/Actions from last meeting: See Action Log
5. Conflicts of Interest: none
6. Health and Safety: item to be included in the agenda. No current issues reported. Jackie has included Near-misses in the Accident Reporting form. QR codes to be available around the Clubhouse to enable reporting, as well as the standard online form.
7. Safeguarding: item to be include in the agenda. Jackie is the Safeguarding Officer, Lesley Stacy-Marks is her deputy. Henry Massey is the responsible officer on the management committee.
Safeguarding training to be increased across all appropriate areas including Sailability, volunteers and the management committee. Certificates to be collated by Jackie.
8. Commodore Update: Focus on increasing number of members in the 25-50 range. No feedback on Kids' club proposal. Still looking for volunteer to run this club.
9. Decision/Discussion items from Section reports
 - Sailing - report accepted.
 - i. Berthing Marshall reviewing policies through Jan/Feb. Kayak policy being updated to match other craft types in requiring volunteer duties. Some concern that some owners are not performing volunteer duties. High

demand for places in the yard. Those not contributing, or not using their boats, are having their places challenged.

ii. 3 Terras bought from Babbacombe Sailing Club to replace one leaking vessel and to increase opportunities for junior sailors – Approved.

Lasers being upgraded. This will increase the number of club boats slightly.

iii. Suggestion to advertise ESC on the sails of club boats.

- Training (including Sailability) – report accepted.

i. Re Options paper - hybrid option selected and agreed. To continue as per last year. Advert for Assistant Pro is live.

ii. Consideration being given to paying some people who teach courses to reduce staff shortages. It is not expected that older trainers would want to be paid, to continue on a voluntary basis. Discussion about increasing external attendance on courses to encourage new membership (current data 80-90% attendance on courses is members). Splash night has attracted many new members and could be advertised more. [Post meeting note: we have to be careful of age discrimination when paying instructors]

- House – report accepted (KBM not present).

Funding for Race Hut repairs agreed (pending d/w MH). Additional suggestions: increase vandal-proofing + tombstoning prevention, reattaching the current signs, and adding more ESC advertising (Planning permission may be required)

- Social – report accepted.

i. Many social events planned in calendar including New Members afternoon and ESC Annual Awards Night (formerly 'Prize Giving').

ii. Great response from young members, led by Becca Neale, with many suggestions to improve the offering and increase social activities for 18-25 years. Opening the area beneath the balcony to social activities was raised – This is permitted as long as plastic drinking vessels are used. Committee agreed JC and BN should proceed with organising young members events.

- Communications – Information gathering ongoing. Strategy for Comms in development, to be shared with committee for comment. Jemma Watson Wakeman has offered to bring her expertise with social media. Request for a comms representative from each area to work with MD and JWW.

Increased working with local newspapers and developing Exe News all planned.

- Bar and Catering – report accepted
 - i. Chef advert live, plan to commence in April.
 - ii. Request from member to consider improving labelling in the kitchen – to be explored with B+C committee
 - iii. Request received to engage volunteers for bar on Saturdays after dinghy racing
 - Financial – report to be received next month (MH away).
10. Complaint Review - A complaint has been received against a member. A behaviour improvement plan has been issued, involving training and counselling. Reviews will be held at 1,3 and 6 month intervals. The member has resigned from roles and responsibilities within the club and has been suspended from the clubhouse. Consideration must be given to communication with staff members and related leads, informing them of actions, while giving consideration to confidentiality.
 11. Complaint Process Review – This event (item 9) has led to a timely review of the complaints process, facilitated by information and opinion from all involved in this event. To be led by VR.
 12. ESC Annual Awards night (formerly known as Prize-Giving) – event is being reviewed with the aim of increasing the audience, bringing new energy to the event, rewarding different groups eg volunteers, members' choice awards. Debbie Woodcock is the organiser, JC to liaise. Date tbc.
 13. New Members Day – afternoon tea and cake. Sunday March 29th.
 14. Exe Regatta Social – ESC has been asked to host this. It will involve considerable effort from teams and volunteers but it was agreed that it was worth investing time and effort exploring options – band, food, max number of guests on site, costs etc.
 15. Kids Club Update – see Commodore's Update (8)
 16. Revised policies on: Bar rules, Code of Conduct, Letting Policy, Hospitality and Smoking were accepted.

Review of Dog Policy: policy of out-of-date. Discussion welcoming dogs in bar. MW to present proposed policy to next meeting.

17. Review of OOP membership – concern has been raised that this type of membership is not used as intended. Clarity has been requested regarding eligibility (eg distance from club), costs and fees, type of membership (individual, family, joint). Any changes must be considered in light of the constitution.

18. AOB:

- i. Incorporation – there has been no negative feedback since the AGM.
- ii. RV raised SCM email sent by Richard Linsdale. All committee are asked to reply and, if training is required, this can be arranged with Richard.
- iii. Equality and Diversity policy was raised and was questioned whether Inclusion should be added. Last reviewed March 2025. Commodore to check.

Next meeting: Monday February 9th 2026

ACTIONS SUMMARY

ACTION	OWNER
ToR: Document to be circulated	Commodore
1 yr review of VHF radio/ emergency phone processes	Commodore April 2026
Dates, Times, Catering for Topper/Terra event required	HM
Admin support for Training team. Commodore to discuss with Of-fice Mgr, Vice to discuss with HM	Commodore, HM
QR codes for Accident and Near-miss reporting to be made available around the club	Commodore to d/w Club Admin Manager
Share safeguarding course link to management committee, volunteers, sailability (Nick Webber) etc. RYA 'Always Safe and Fun'. Certificates to be collated by Office Manager Jackie	HM
Increased ESC advertising on Race hut - planning permission	KBM
Purchase and installation of exterior changing room door – order to issued imminently	KBM
Stairlift guidance to be placed on notice boards	Club Admin Manager
Dinghy to Rescue boat ratio – absolute vs dynamic assessment to be discussed with RV – Ongoing - New Dinghy Captain appointed. To be discussed this week	Commodore
Catering for Zoe and the Ravens night to be arranged	JC

Advertising on club boats to be researched	MD
Advertising for Splash Nights -social media	HM and MD
Stream-lining of processes/ provision of Standard Operating Procedures (SOP) for club and private social functions - ongoing	GS, Commodore
Review of B+C incident report	Commodore + GS
Risk Register development. Commodore to review.	VR, MH
Quotes for kitchen cooling systems and AC replacement in restaurant and dining area to be obtained. Cellar quote completed.	KBM and GS
Further quotes for cladding - ongoing	KBM
List of trained PAT testers to be drawn up and managed. Annual testing to be compliant - ongoing	KBM
Weekly fire alarm testing documentation -ongoing	KBM
All area leads to identify person to work with the Comms Team	All Officers
Share Comms strategy document with the committee	MD
Liaise with Rob Adams re access to social media (who?)	MD
Opening of area beneath balcony for social activity – check licensing and H+S eg plastic glasses	JC, Commodore
Consider kitchen labelling	GS
Consider Saturday post dinghy racing bar	GS
Comms related to complaint informing relevant teams and leads	Commodore, RV
Review of Complaints Process and policy	VR
Awards night discussions with Debbie Woodcock, date tbc	JC
GDPR compliance and WhatsApp groups - newsletter and privacy letter complete. Trial of Spond ongoing	Commodore, KBM
Equality and Diversity policy to include Inclusion	Commodore
New members day date to be d/w Nick Webber	JC
Exe Regatta Social event to be explored	Commodore, JC, GS
Draft new dog policy	Commodore
Check legality of paying only some instructors (added post meeting)	Commodore, HM